

# On Restraint

A single page on why less is often more — rendered through the same pipeline that will produce your longer documents.

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## THE CASE

Good design removes what doesn't earn its place. **Every element competes for attention**, and *most attention budgets are small*. A page with fewer signals lets the remaining ones mean more.

When the default is restraint, an accent — `inline code`, a blockquote, a rule — lands with weight. When everything shouts, nothing does.

## On Mono

The `JetBrains Mono` face is reserved for code, filenames, and tracked labels. Used everywhere, it would read as terminal output. Used here, it marks the signals of “system”: things the reader is meant to parse precisely.

## On Sans

Archivo carries the body and the headings — one family, one voice. It is a reading face that scales up cleanly to a 21pt display heading without changing character. Its job, at body size, is to get out of the way.

## On Serif

Instrument Serif appears only as ornament: the italic folio at the foot of the page, pull quotes, the suffix of a cover title. It is never used for running prose — italics inside a paragraph stay in Archivo, so the serif keeps its rarity.

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## THE QUOTE

Perfection is achieved, not when there is nothing more to add, but when there is nothing left to take away.

— Antoine de Saint-Exupéry, who flew mail planes.

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## THE ASIDE

Further reading lives at [typographica.org](https://typographica.org), among other places. The links in this document render in black with an underline — enough to read as interactive, not enough to interrupt.